
HS 546: Readings in World Literature

Course Code	HS 546
Course Name	Readings in World Literature
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	Undergraduate and Postgraduate
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	50th BoA (Jul 2023)

Course Contents

- Topic 1: Concepts of “World Literature” – an overview (6 hours)
 - Weltliteratur
 - Comparative / world literature
 - Vishwa-sahitya
 - Centres and peripheries
 - Distant reading
 - Untranslatability
- Topic 2: Reading across time (9 hours)
 - The classics
 - The literary canon
 - Prize-winning authors
 - Forms and mutations
 - Colonial / postcolonial writing
- Topic 3: Reading across space (9 hours)
 - The nationalist and the provincial
 - The cosmopolitan writer
 - Planetarity and universalism
 - The literary marketplace
 - Travel, migration, and diaspora
 - Alternative communities
- Topic 4: Reading in translation (9 hours)
 - Role of the translator
 - The bilingual / multilingual writer
 - Hierarchies of languages
 - Translation and gender
 - Untranslatability
- Topic 5: Reading across cultures (9 hours)
 - World literature as a mode of reading
 - Resistance and diffusion
 - The multicultural text
 - Globalization
 - New media and the World Wide Web

Text Books

1. Damrosch, D. et al., The Princeton Sourcebook in Comparative Literature, Princeton University Press, USA, 2009/2021.
2. Martin Puchner, The Norton Anthology of World Literature (Shorter 4th Edition), Vol. 1 & 2, W. W. Norton & Company, USA, 2021.

References

Readings

1. For Topic 1
 - (a) Johann Wolfgang Goethe, 'Conversations on Weltliteratur'
 - (b) Rabindranath Tagore, 'Vishwa-Sahitya'
 - (c) Frederic Jameson, 'Third-World Literature in the Era of Multinational Capitalism'
 - (d) Franco Moretti, 'Conjectures on World Literature and More Conjectures'
 - (e) David Damrosch, 'Conclusion' from What is World Literature?
 - (f) Writing About World Literature by Karen Gocsik (first two chapters)
2. For Topic 2
 - (a) Homer, The Iliad, Book 1 (The Wrath of Achilles)
 - (b) Vyasa, The Mahabharata, Book 5 (The Temptation of Karna)
 - (c) Tales from The Thousand and One Nights
 - (d) Doris Lessing, 'The Old Chief Mshlanga'
 - (e) T. S. Eliot, 'What is a Classic?' and 'Tradition and the Individual Talent'
 - (f) Ankhi Mukherjee, 'Introduction' in What is a Classic?
3. For Topic 3
 - (a) W. B. Yeats, 'The Lake Isle of Innisfree'
 - (b) Louis Aragon, 'The Rose and the Reseda'
 - (c) Sadat Hasan Manto, 'Toba Tek Singh' • Julio Cortázar, 'House Taken Over'
 - (d) Sheldon Pollock, 'Cosmopolitanisms'
 - (e) Judith Butler, 'Universality in Culture'
 - (f) Pheng Cheah, 'What is a World? On World Literature as World-making Activity'
4. For Topic 4
 - (a) Rabindranath Tagore, 'The Hungry Stones'
 - (b) Nikolai Gogol, 'Diary of a Madman'
 - (c) Lu Xun, 'Diary of a Madman'
 - (d) Samuel Beckett, Not I
 - (e) Gayatri Spivak, 'The Politics of Translation'
 - (f) Emily Apter, 'A New Comparative Literature'
5. For Topic 5
 - (a) J. M. Coetzee, 'The Dog'
 - (b) Yoko Tawada, 'The Bridegroom was a Dog'
 - (c) Kow Shih Li, 'Peach Blossom Luck'
 - (d) Marjane Satrapi, selections from Persepolis
 - (e) Jorge Luis Borges, 'The Argentine Writer and Tradition'
 - (f) Salman Rushdie, 'Imaginary Homelands'

Further references

1. Apter, E. 2013. Against World Literature: On the Politics of Untranslatability. London: Verso.
2. Bassnett, S. (Ed) 2019. Translation and World Literature. New York: Routledge.
3. Casanova, P. 2004. The World Republic of Letters. Trans. M. B. DeBevoise. Cambridge: Harvard University Press.
4. Damrosch, D. 2003. What is World Literature? Princeton: Princeton University Press.
5. Dev, A. and Das, S. K. 1988. Comparative Literature: Theory and Practice. Shimla: IIAS.
6. Mufti, A. 2016. Forget English! Orientalisms and World Literatures. Cambridge: Harvard University Press.
7. Mukherjee, A. 2014. What is a Classic? Postcolonial Rewriting and Invention of the Canon. Stanford: Stanford University Press.
8. Ramakrishnan, E. V. et al (Eds). 2013. Interdisciplinary Alter-Natives in Comparative Literature. New Delhi: Sage.
9. Zepetnek, S., & Mukherjee, T. (Eds.). 2014. Companion to Comparative Literature, World Literatures, and Comparative Cultural Studies. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.